



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/22

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2023

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A: The benefits of listening to podcasts

The writer of this blog entry works as a sales representative for a clothing company.

Podcasts have been around for years, but I have only recently discovered what a great use of time they are. Most of my work colleagues always seemed to have their earphones in, but what were they listening to? I had heard of podcasts. I knew they were a kind of audio programme you could subscribe to and listen to, for example on your smartphone, whenever you like. I had not realised how much I would enjoy them, especially when faced with administrative tasks in the office. I whizz through those boring tasks now. 5

Podcasts come in a variety of lengths, so it's easy to listen to an episode even if I only have half an hour between meetings or video calls with clients. If you don't finish listening in one sitting, they're always at your disposal on your phone, computer, or tablet to pick back up later. The best podcasts sound like you are listening to a real conversation. They can really help to relieve stress and give you something interesting to talk about at break. 10

Outside of work, I use podcasts to help me focus while running, cooking, and even cleaning (I get more done that way). Friends joke that I am in my 'own little podcast world' most of the time. Topics that I enjoy most include health, fashion and exercise – I find them incredibly motivational. I subscribe to about 150 podcasts, and to fit them all in have started to 'podfast' (listening to podcasts on double, sometimes triple speed, which I'm noticing boosts my energy levels). 15

Many studies on the benefits of podcasts show that they help us to become better listeners and have a greater appreciation for simply listening. Podcasts stimulate mental imagery more intensely than anything we watch or read.

There is nothing to lose by making podcasts a part of your regular lifestyle. Whether you want to learn a new skill for work, keep up with the news or need to be inspired, there is a podcast for you! I don't listen to music as much any more as there's so much out there to learn about. Podcasts offer a vast range of topics and for the most part they're free. 20

There truly is something for everyone.

Text B: I listen to 35 hours of podcasts every week. Is that bad?

A few weeks ago, I caught the bus back from work, and before I even sat down, started rummaging in my backpack for my earphones.

Content removed due to copyright restrictions.

While these studies don't specifically look at the difference between music and spoken content, could saturating our minds with information in audio form be just as problematic as spending every waking hour consuming any other kind of media?

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You will need: Insert (enclosed)

- Answer **two** questions in total:
Section A: answer Question 1.
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Question 1

Write a letter to persuade your boss that staff should be allowed to listen to podcasts in their workplace.

- evaluate the ideas, attitudes and opinions about podcasts given in both texts
- consider the concerns your boss might have
- suggest some of the benefits of staff listening to podcasts, based on what you have read, for both the staff and the business.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines, typical of primary school handwriting practice paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the entire width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

[Turn to page 6 for Section B]

Section B: Composition

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER

Descriptive Writing

2 Describe an object that has been broken for a long time.

OR

Descriptive Writing

3 Write a description with the title 'A special building – inside and outside'.

OR

Narrative Writing

4 Write a story that includes the words '... I realised I had been here before ...'.

OR

Narrative Writing

5 Write a story with the title 'The ball'.

Please write your chosen question number here (2, 3, 4, 5):

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of multiple rows of horizontal dashed lines spaced evenly down the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The background is plain white, and there are no other markings or text present.

Blank lined paper for writing.

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